



### Map stitcher

Use this software to take 4K images exported from Inkarnate and put them together into an even bigger map. <https://digit.in/jun20-74>



### Dungeondraft

A very useful software for creating dungeons and battlemaps for your RPG campaigns. <https://digit.in/jun20-75>

can play tricks with the perspective with a custom background, converting an isometric view to 3D. The background has been created in a software called Bryce. When rendering, you will have to use the target resolution that is the same as the document, which in this case is 6,793x8,192. In a 3D rendering software or an image editing tool, paint or create the background that you intend to use. A 8,192x6,144 map allows an image of 2,048x1,536 pixels dimensions to fit perfectly on a texture layer, with the size set at 100 percent. The required sizes for other images have to be calculated relative to these numbers. Inkarnate allows you to use a texture upto 4,096 pixels along its length or width. Once you have exported your image, fire up Inkarnate and mask the entire background. Select the Brush tool then click on the Texture Catalogue under the Brush Options window in the right, and then upload the file that you have created. This background is permanently tied to your Inkarnate account unless you remove it. Now paint the map, and viola, you are using a custom background. The feature is incredibly useful for making variations of a single map. Just export a base version of a map, and re-import it as a texture.

### USING CUSTOM STAMPS

Although Inkarnate has a large library of stamps, it is quite possible that some exact thing that you require is not available. For example, there are no farm animals, stables or troughs at this point of time. If you want to add these objects to your map. Now, a crucial step that you have to do for projects like this is to export a blank version of the map. This is because if there are objects that are in front of each other, then a background allows you to selec-

tively erase out portions of the map, to position an object between layers in an image editing software later. A similar approach will also have to be used for positioning a new asset sandwiched between two layers of the final map. For example, to add a horse partially inside a shed, you have to use the map in layer 1, the horse in layer 2 and the map again in layer 3. From layer 3, you have to delete out

get these assets into your map without drawing them from scratch. The next thing is to look in 3D asset sites such as cadnav, cgtrader or 3dmb. Once you have downloaded files from these sites, use a free 3D rendering software such as Blender to create an image from an isometric point of view. Be sure to use a blank or easily removable background. The shadows in Inkarnate are from the top right.

The shadow can either be created in the 3D software, or in the image editing software. Check out the Inkarnate subreddit for more ideas.

### THE FUNCTION OF GRIDS

Inkarnate allows you to use grids in two ways. The masking tool allows you to even create the landmasses according to the grids, if you want to create pixel-y maps. However, grids are useful even in the smaller battlemaps for encounters, such as a dungeon or a bandit camp. The grids are not turned on by default. At the bottom of the toolbox is the show grid button. This lets you pick between three types of grids, square, isometric square, and hexagons. Now, the important thing to note here is that you need to plan out your maps according to the grid in a certain way. In a single turn, if a person can move 30 meters, you need to represent a factor

of 30 such as 10, 5 or 3. This means the sizes of the elements in the map have to be relative to a single cell, which is say 10 meters. A player character can cross 3 cells in a single turn. This is not a constraint really, but allows you to carefully plan incredible encounters on your maps. It is also possible to adjust the transparency of the grid, and even export the same map with the grid visible and invisible. Another option is to print a grid on a transparency, and always use the same grid on all your maps. This way, the transparency can be slapped on to a printed map whenever it is required. 



A bandit camp with a custom background as well as custom assets

everything but the roof of the shed. So the neck of the horse is outside the shed, but the back is within. As for the custom assets themselves, they can be found on the web and then used with an image editing tool, which is fine for private uses. Some useful keywords are "render" for transparency and "isometric" for the viewing angle used in Inkarnate, and other mapping tools. You can also look for "sprite" for assets typically used in the development of video games. If you want something a bit more exotic, such as a laughing buddha statue, then there is still a way to